



HR Policy Overview

A comprehensive guide to our human resource policies, workplace standards, and organizational values designed to empower every employee of our company and build a thriving, compliant and people first organization.

Purpose

This HR Policy Overview sets out the employment principles, workplace standards, and people practices applicable within the organization. Its purpose is to provide employees with clear guidance on employment terms, attendance, conduct, leave, performance expectations, workplace safety, and statutory compliance. This policy is designed for a management consulting organization operating in Uttar Pradesh, India, with a work-from-office model.

Scope

This policy applies to all employees of the organization, including full-time, part-time, probationary, confirmed, fixed-term, trainees, interns, and consultants to the extent specifically stated in their engagement terms. Where any provision of this policy differs from applicable law, the law shall prevail. The organization may amend this policy from time to time to meet business, legal, or operational requirements.

Workplace Model and Working Hours

The organization follows a work-from-office model. Employees are required to work from the designated office location unless a written exception has been approved by management.

- Working days are Monday to Friday.
- Working hours are 10:00 AM to 6:00 PM.
- Employees are expected to report on time and remain available for work during scheduled hours.
- Reasonable lunch and rest breaks may be taken in accordance with operational requirements and manager guidance.
- Employees may be required to work beyond normal hours based on client commitments, business exigencies, or project deadlines, subject to applicable law.
- Weekly off days are ordinarily Saturday and Sunday, unless business needs require otherwise.

Employment Categories

- The organization may engage individuals under different employment categories depending on business needs.
- Probationary employees are those serving an initial evaluation period.
- Confirmed employees are those who have successfully completed probation and received written confirmation.
- Fixed-term employees are engaged for a specified duration under a written contract.
- Part-time employees work fewer hours than full-time employees as per their appointment terms.
- Trainees and interns are engaged for learning and development purposes under defined terms.

Appointment And Probation

All appointments shall be made through a formal appointment letter or employment contract stating designation, compensation, reporting structure, place of work, and key terms of employment. New employees may be placed on probation for a period specified in their appointment letter. During probation, performance, conduct, attendance, and suitability for the role will be assessed.

The organization may extend probation where performance or conduct requires further review, subject to applicable law and written communication. Confirmation of employment shall be effective only upon written confirmation by the organization.

Equal Employment Opportunity And Non-Discrimination

The organization is committed to fair and equitable employment practices. Employment-related decisions including hiring, training, compensation, promotion, transfer, discipline, and separation shall be based on merit, qualifications, performance, business needs, and lawful considerations.

The organization does not tolerate unlawful discrimination on grounds protected under applicable Indian law, including sex, religion, caste, disability, or any other legally protected characteristic. Employees are expected to maintain a respectful and inclusive workplace.

Code Of Conduct

Employees shall maintain high standards of integrity, professionalism, and ethical conduct at all times. As a management consulting organization, the organization places particular importance on confidentiality, client trust, accuracy, and professional behaviour.

- Employees shall act honestly and in the best interests of the organization.
- Employees shall treat colleagues, clients, vendors, and visitors with dignity and respect.
- Employees shall comply with lawful instructions issued by authorized managers.
- Employees shall avoid abusive, threatening, discriminatory, or disruptive behavior.
- Employees shall not engage in fraud, bribery, corruption, theft, falsification of records, or misuse of organizational assets.
- Employees shall maintain appropriate standards of dress, grooming, and workplace etiquette consistent with a formal office environment.
- Employees shall not report to work under the influence of alcohol, narcotics, or other intoxicating substances.

Attendance And Punctuality

- Employees must record attendance through the prescribed system or process.
- Late arrival, early departure, or absence without approval may result in loss of pay, disciplinary action, or both.
- Employees who are unable to attend work must inform their reporting manager and the designated HR contact as early as possible, preferably before the start of the workday.
- Repeated irregular attendance may be treated as misconduct.

- Absence without information or authorization may be treated as unauthorized absence and may lead to disciplinary action.

Compensation And Payroll

- Employees shall be paid salary and other approved components in accordance with their appointment terms and applicable law. Salary shall ordinarily be processed monthly, subject to statutory deductions and authorized adjustments.
- Statutory deductions may include provident fund, professional tax where applicable, income tax deducted at source, employee state insurance where applicable, and any other lawful deductions.
- No employee may receive unauthorized payments, reimbursements, or benefits.
- Salary advances, loans, or special payments, if any, shall be governed by separate approval processes.
- Final settlement upon separation shall be processed subject to clearance, recovery of dues, and applicable timelines under law.

Performance Management

- Employees shall receive goals, responsibilities, or deliverables from their reporting manager.
- The organization follows a performance-driven culture. Employees are expected to meet role expectations, quality standards, timelines, and behavioural requirements. Performance may be reviewed periodically through formal or informal processes.
- Performance reviews may consider quality of work, productivity, client service, teamwork, initiative, attendance, and adherence to organizational values.
- Performance improvement measures may be initiated where performance falls below expectations.
- Compensation revisions, incentives, promotions, and role changes shall be based on performance, business conditions, and management discretion.

Leave Policy

The organization provides leave in accordance with applicable law and business requirements. Employees must apply for leave through the prescribed process and obtain approval in advance, except in

emergencies. Leave misuse, false claims, or absence beyond approved leave may result in disciplinary action.

Casual Leave

Casual leave may be granted for urgent or unforeseen personal matters, subject to approval and operational feasibility.

- Casual leave should ordinarily be applied for in advance.
- Casual leave cannot be claimed as a matter of right and may be restricted during critical business periods.
- Unused casual leave may lapse at the end of the leave year unless otherwise provided by law or internal rules.

Sick Leave

Sick leave may be granted when an employee is unable to work due to illness, injury, or medical reasons.

- The employee must inform the reporting manager at the earliest opportunity.
- A medical certificate may be required for absence beyond the period specified by the organization or where misuse is suspected.
- The organization may require a fitness certificate before resumption of duties in appropriate cases.

Earned Leave OR Privilege Leave

Eligible employees may accrue earned leave or privilege leave in accordance with applicable law, including the Uttar Pradesh Shops and Commercial Establishments framework where applicable to the organization.

- Earned leave should be planned and applied for in advance.
- Approval shall depend on staffing and business requirements.

- Carry forward and encashment, if permitted, shall be governed by applicable law and organizational rules.

Public Holidays And Weekly Offs

The organization shall observe notified national holidays and such festival or other holidays as determined each year in accordance with applicable law and business needs. Weekly offs are ordinarily Saturday and Sunday.

- Employees may be required to work on a holiday due to business exigencies.
- Where employees work on a holiday, compensatory off or other treatment shall be provided in accordance with applicable law and organizational practice.

Maternity Leave

The organization shall provide maternity benefits in accordance with the Maternity Benefit Act, 1961, as amended, where applicable. Eligible employees shall be entitled to maternity leave and related benefits as prescribed by law.

- Employees should provide reasonable advance notice and supporting medical documentation.
- The organization shall not discriminate against an employee on account of pregnancy, childbirth, or related medical conditions.
- Any additional benefits such as nursing breaks shall be provided in accordance with applicable law.

Paternity Leave and Adoption Leave

Paternity leave or adoption-related leave may be granted if provided under the employees appointment terms or internal practice. Where not mandated by law, such leave shall be subject to organizational discretion and communicated policy rules.

Leave Without Pay

Leave without pay may be granted in exceptional circumstances where paid leave is unavailable or insufficient, subject to

management approval. Such leave may affect salary, benefits, statutory contributions, and continuity-related calculations to the extent permitted by law.

Misuse Of Leave

Providing false reasons, forged medical documents, or taking leave without approval may be treated as misconduct and may result in disciplinary action.

Overtime And Additional Working Time

Employees may occasionally be required to work beyond scheduled hours due to client deadlines, project demands, audits, or business continuity needs. Overtime eligibility, approval, and compensation shall be governed by applicable law, employee category, and internal authorization rules.

Employees shall not assume overtime entitlement unless specifically approved and legally applicable.

Travel And Client Assignments

As part of management consulting operations, employees may be required to travel for client meetings, training, business development, or project execution.

- Official travel must be authorized in advance unless emergency circumstances apply.
- Employees shall follow approved travel, expense, and reimbursement procedures.
- Employees are expected to maintain professional conduct during travel and at client locations.
- Expenses must be reasonable, business-related, supported by valid documentation, and submitted within prescribed timelines.

Expense Reimbursement

The organization shall reimburse approved business expenses incurred in the course of employment, subject to policy limits and documentation requirements.

- Claims must be accurate, complete, and supported by bills or receipts where required.
- False, inflated, duplicate, or unauthorized claims may lead to disciplinary action.
- Reimbursement timelines may depend on submission quality, approvals, and payroll cycles.

Confidentiality And Data Protection

Employees shall maintain strict confidentiality regarding all non-public information relating to the organization, its clients, employees, vendors, finances, strategies, systems, and intellectual property. This obligation applies during and after employment.

- Confidential information shall be used only for legitimate business purposes.
- Employees shall not disclose confidential information to unauthorized persons inside or outside the organization.
- Client data, project materials, proposals, reports, pricing, and internal documents must be handled with due care.
- Passwords, access credentials, and sensitive records must be protected at all times.
- Employees shall comply with applicable data protection and privacy requirements and internal information security practices.

Intellectual Property

Any work product, report, presentation, model, framework, analysis, document, software, database, design, or other material created by an employee in the course of employment or using organizational resources shall belong to the organization, unless otherwise agreed in writing and subject to applicable law.

Employees shall promptly disclose and assign such work product to the organization and shall not use or distribute it without authorization.

Use Of Organizational Property And Systems

- Employees are responsible for the proper use and safekeeping of organizational property, including laptops, mobile devices, access cards, documents, software, furniture, and other assets.
- Organizational systems and internet access are primarily for business use.
- Limited personal use may be permitted if it does not interfere with work, create security risks, or violate policy.
- Employees shall not install unauthorized software, access unlawful content, or misuse communication systems.
- All assets must be returned upon demand, transfer, suspension, or separation.

Conflict Of Interest

- Employees must avoid situations in which personal interests conflict, or appear to conflict, with the interests of the organization or its clients.
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- Employees shall disclose any actual or potential conflict of interest to HR or management.
- Employees shall not engage in outside employment, consulting, business activity, or directorship that interferes with their duties or creates a conflict, without prior written approval.
- Employees shall not accept gifts, favors, commissions, or benefits that may improperly influence business decisions.

Anti-Bribery And Ethical Business Conduct

The organization prohibits bribery, kickbacks, facilitation payments, and corrupt practices in any form. Employees must comply with all applicable anti-corruption laws and maintain accurate records of transactions and expenses.

- No employee may offer, promise, give, solicit, or accept any improper advantage.
- Any suspected unethical conduct must be reported immediately.

Prevention Of Sexual Harassment

- The organization is committed to providing a workplace free from sexual harassment in accordance with the Sexual Harassment of Women at Workplace (Prevention, Prohibition and Redressal) Act, 2013. Sexual harassment in any form is strictly prohibited.
- The organization shall maintain an Internal Committee as required by law, where applicable.
- Employees may report complaints of sexual harassment through the prescribed grievance channels.
- Complaints shall be handled promptly, sensitively, fairly, and confidentially to the extent possible.
- Retaliation against a complainant, witness, or participant in an inquiry is prohibited.
- False or malicious complaints may attract action in accordance with law, while ensuring that inability to prove a complaint does not by itself amount to a false complaint.

Workplace Health, Safety, And Security

The organization is committed to maintaining a safe and secure office environment. Employees must comply with all safety instructions, emergency procedures, and security protocols.

- Employees shall keep work areas clean and free from hazards.
- Accidents, injuries, unsafe conditions, or security incidents must be reported immediately.

- Employees shall cooperate during fire drills, evacuations, and emergency response procedures.
- Smoking shall be permitted only in designated areas, if any, and in accordance with law.
- Weapons, hazardous materials, and unlawful substances are prohibited on organizational premises.

Grievance Redressal

The organization encourages employees to raise workplace concerns in a timely and respectful manner. Grievances relating to employment conditions, workplace behaviour, managerial actions, or policy interpretation may be submitted to the reporting manager or HR.

- Employees should first attempt to resolve routine concerns through their reporting manager where appropriate.
- If the matter is sensitive or unresolved, employees may approach HR directly.
- The organization shall review grievances fairly and take appropriate action based on facts and applicable policy.
- Retaliation against an employee for raising a genuine concern in good faith is prohibited.

Disciplinary Action

Violation of this policy, misconduct, poor performance, insubordination, unauthorized absence, breach of confidentiality, harassment, fraud, theft, violence, or other unacceptable conduct may result in disciplinary action. The organization shall follow principles of fairness and applicable legal requirements before imposing major disciplinary measures.

- Disciplinary action may include verbal warning, written warning, suspension, loss of privileges, performance improvement measures, recovery of losses where lawful, or termination of employment.

- ~~Serious misconduct may warrant immediate action, including suspension pending inquiry or termination, subject to applicable law.~~
- Employees may be required to participate in investigations and provide truthful information.

Separation From Employment

Employment may end by resignation, retirement, expiry of fixed term, termination, discharge, abandonment of service, or death. Employees are expected to complete all exit formalities in a timely manner.

Resignation

An employee wishing to resign must submit a written resignation and serve the notice period stated in the appointment letter, unless waived or modified by the organization in writing.

- The organization may accept resignation with immediate effect, require full notice service, or provide payment in lieu where contractually or legally permissible.
- During notice period, employees must continue to perform duties diligently and support transition requirements.

Termination By The Organization

The organization may terminate employment for reasons including misconduct, poor performance, redundancy, business restructuring, prolonged unauthorized absence, breach of policy, or other lawful grounds, subject to applicable law, contractual terms, and due process requirements.

Abandonment Of Service

If an employee remains absent without authorization or communication for a prolonged period, the organization may treat the matter as abandonment of service after following reasonable notice and process requirements.

Exit Clearance And Final Settlement

On separation, employees must return all organizational property, documents, data, credentials, and assets. Final settlement shall be subject to clearance from relevant departments and lawful deductions for recoverable dues, if any.

- Confidentiality and intellectual property obligations continue after separation.
- Experience letters or relieving documents may be issued in accordance with organizational practice after completion of exit formalities.

Records And Documentation

Employees must provide accurate personal, educational, banking, tax, and statutory information at the time of joining and whenever updates occur. Submission of false information or forged documents may result in withdrawal of offer, disciplinary action, or termination.

The organization may maintain employee records in physical or electronic form in accordance with legal and operational requirements.

Statutory Compliance

The organization shall comply with applicable employment laws in India and Uttar Pradesh, including laws relating to wages, working conditions, leave, maternity benefits, social security, workplace safety, and prevention of sexual harassment, as applicable to the establishment and employee category.

Employees are expected to cooperate in all compliance-related processes, including submission of declarations, identity documents, tax information, and statutory forms.

Management Rights

The organization reserves the right to interpret, administer, modify, suspend, or withdraw this policy in whole or in part, subject to applicable law. Nothing in this policy creates a guarantee of employment for any fixed duration unless expressly stated in a written contract.

Employee Responsibilities

- Understand and comply with this policy and all related procedures.
- Maintain regular attendance, punctuality, and professional conduct.
- Protect confidential information and organizational assets.
- Follow lawful instructions and cooperate with managers and HR.
- Raise concerns promptly through appropriate channels.
- Comply with all legal, ethical, and workplace safety requirements.

Manager Responsibilities

- Communicate expectations clearly and manage teams fairly.
- Approve attendance, leave, and work assignments responsibly.
- Promote respectful behavior and address misconduct promptly.
- Maintain confidentiality in employee matters.
- Support compliance with legal and organizational requirements.

HR Responsibilities

- Administer this policy consistently and fairly.
- Maintain employee records and statutory documentation.
- Support grievance handling, disciplinary processes, and employee communication.
- Guide managers and employees on policy interpretation and compliance.
- Review and update policies as required by law and business needs.

Acknowledgement

All employees are expected to read, understand, and comply with this HR Policy Overview. Continued employment with the organization constitutes an expectation of adherence to these standards, subject to applicable law and written employment terms.